

Source: Picture tweeted by UP Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on 13 November 2020, with a message saying 'the world record is dedicated to all Ram-Bhakts', https://twitter.com/myogiadityanath/status/1327288747558199296?s=20

Doordarshan's UP channel broadcast the lamp-lighting in Ayodhya live for almost seven hours on 13 November 2020. With drone-mounted cameras relaying aerial pictures of 'darshan' from the city, this programming on the state-owned network was unambiguous about what it thought the first Diwali in Ayodhya after the SC judgement signified. It was presented by commentators on the network as the 'ending of 500 years of darkness', as a 'gaurav-poorn pal' (pride-filled moment) coming after a 'centuries-long struggle' by 'itni peedhiyan' (so many generations) and the 'aahuti' (religious sacrifice) of 'lakhs of followers' for 'asmita'. Doordarshan also glorified the role of two leaders of the Ram Temple movement: Mahant Digvijay Nath (Hindu Mahasabha leader and Gorakhpur MP in 1967), who played a leading role in the emergence of the Ram Lalla idols in the Babri Masjid in 1949, and Mahant Avaidyanath (MLA from Maniram in 1967, 1969, 1974 and 1977; Gorakhpur MP in 1970, 1989, 1991 and 1996)—both Yogi Adityanath's predecessors as head of the Gorakhnath Math. The narrative virtually legitimised the demolition of the Babri Masjid, without actually saying so. It